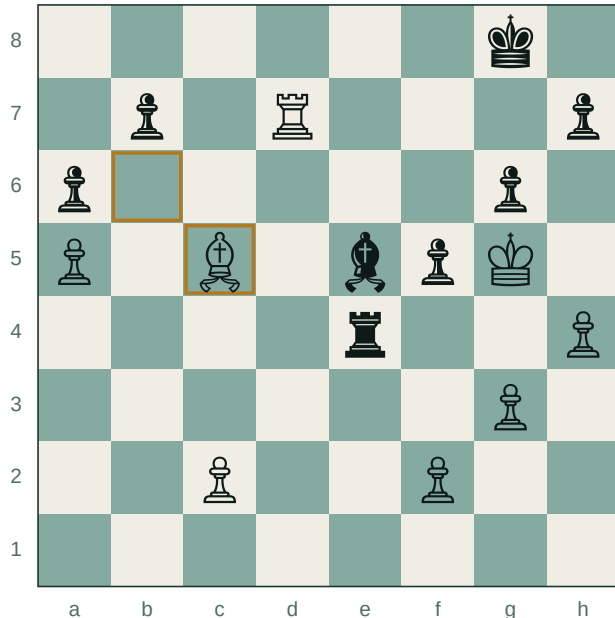


Mate in three: Black, move 34

Mate in three

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Bc5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...Rg4+ 35. Kh6 Rxh4+ 36. gxh4 Bf4#

34...Rg4+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **35.Kh6**.

35...Rxh4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on h4. Recorded reply: **36.gxh4**.

36...Bf4# Mate: bishop on f4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Bishop on f4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

HOW TO LOOK

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: rook on d7 and bishop on c5. Check for tactical protection.